

## Chapter 122\_1 - Jealousy

"Sorry." Chu Qingqiu spoke from the side, her eyes showing some panic. "I..."

Indeed, she was no longer able to easily control her emotions as she used to.

"It's fine." Jiuying waved her hand and lovingly picked up the poor roasted chicken, forcing a smile.

"I picked it up quickly, it's still edible."

"She has never told me in detail about what happened back then." Chu Qingqiu looked at Baili Shiqi through the blazing flames, who was chatting and laughing on the opposite side, and spoke softly.

"Actually, there's nothing much to tell." Jiuying tore off a piece of meat and put it in her mouth. "If the Divine Venerable doesn't ask, it doesn't matter. Or you could ask Ning Fuyi. If she doesn't speak, I certainly don't dare to say anything carelessly."

Chu Qingqiu's eyes flickered with the flames, and she said no more.

"Everyone, let's continue once we've recovered our strength. Don't delay too much." Tang Wenshu stood up and spoke gently, then looked toward Ning Fuyi. "Fuyi, you three are weak in numbers. Why don't you travel with us? It would provide mutual support."

Before Ning Fuyi could answer, Hua Feiwu became displeased and jumped up from the ground defiantly: "Uncle Tang, don't trust this woman, lest you be used by her later!"

"Hua Feiwu." Tang Wenshu sternly interrupted his words. "I am old friends with Master Ning Tian<sup>1</sup> as well. Given her character, the disciple she taught surely wouldn't be lacking either."

After saying this, he looked at Ning Fuyi once more, nodded, then stood up to extinguish the campfire and headed toward the depths of the cave.

Ning Fuyi smiled slightly and didn't even glance at Hua Feiwu.

Qiu Yi was still unconscious. Chu Qingqiu secretly cast a spell to store her in her sleeve, and like someone with something on her mind, silently followed at the back of the group.

Ning Fuyi looked at her retreating figure, her eyes flowing with emotion, and quietly followed.

This cave wasn't dug by the group just now, but was naturally formed. After the group fled in panic from the stone formation and accidentally fell, they discovered that the cave beneath their feet actually had connecting passages.

"I was the one who accidentally fell down!" Baili Shiqi said with some pride.

Passing through the low cave entrance, a crevice less than one person's height appeared before them. It had no artificial traces and should have been formed by weathering. Tang Wenshu cast a spell to make his sword tip emit points of light, then bent down to proceed forward.

Before long, the space suddenly opened up in front of them. Looking up, they had already walked out of the rock crevice. The dim light illuminated the surroundings, and they heard Baili Shiqi let out a "wow."

Below their feet was dry earth scattered with remnants of carriages, horses, houses, and buildings. Around them were some still relatively tall dark silhouettes that looked like houses.

Hua Feiwu was also quite amazed. He bent down to wipe away a layer of dust and dug out a wine vessel that was mostly broken. The wine vessel was made of clay with an extremely ancient style, and the sense of age hit them immediately.

"Could this be the Xuanyuan Kingdom ruins?" Hua Feiwu said excitedly. "A realm lost for ten thousand years, and now we've actually found it! Brother, come take a look!"

Only then did Ning Fuyi notice Hua Feihua, who had been silent all along. After hearing Hua Feiwu's words, he didn't step forward but stood alone in a corner.

Ning Fuyi had heard of these two brothers from the Flying Flower Sect. She had seen them once when Hua Feiwu bullied Rong Jin, but this was the first time she had encountered his older brother Hua Feihua face to face.

This person was indeed well-dressed and steady.

"There are wheel ruts on the ground." Tang Wenshu's words drew Ning Fuyi's attention back. "This place should have been a prosperous street tens of thousands of years ago, but it suffered some great disaster overnight, which caused the city to sink and become ruins."

"Then it seems we've found the right place." Liu Wenzhu also touched the ground, then similarly summoned points of light to illuminate the darkness ahead.

The group moved forward silently. Along the way, there were traces showing the conditions from tens of thousands of years ago. Some objects were well-preserved, while others could no longer be identified.

Fortunately, there was no wind or water here, so the basic appearance of the city could still be discerned.

"Look, what is that!" A Tianxuan Sword Sect disciple suddenly cried out in alarm. He was so frightened that he kept backing away. Fortunately, Tang Wenshu was behind him and grabbed his collar, lifting him up and placing him far away.

"Not good, it's thick miasma again. Everyone be careful!" Tang Wenshu said, then stretched out his hands to form seals. His two sleeves brought up a breeze, and then a light blue, water-like barrier began from above his head, enveloping everyone.

Ning Fuyi looked up and saw that thick miasma had risen somewhere not far away. It looked like rolling black smoke, just like a giant worm, swallowing the broken walls and ruins bit by bit into its body.

At this time, Chu Qingqiu also shook her sleeves, and hurricane winds immediately swept past everyone, rushing toward the thick miasma. However, the miasma seemed able to devour everything. Such strong winds only made it retreat slightly before it quickly returned.

Everyone saw her beautiful appearance and silent demeanor, never expecting her to have such cultivation. This made Baili Shiqi excitedly clap her hands: "Who would have thought Miss Su's immortal power was so outstanding!"

"Outstanding my ass, but it still can't make this thick miasma dissipate!" Hua Feiwu was so frightened that he stuttered, his dissolute appearance no longer existing, and his speech became unguarded.

Ning Fuyi's dark eyebrows furrowed slightly. She silently flicked out a stream of qi, pushing him toward the miasma. This frightened Hua Feiwu into howling loudly. Fortunately, when he flew past Hua Feihua, he was pulled back, narrowly avoiding diving headfirst into the miasma.

However, the situation was now urgent, and no one had time to pay attention to him. Jiuying said: "This thick miasma can't be moved by wind or burned by fire, and even barriers are useless. What should we do?"

"Don't panic. Although this is miasma, it's different from those outside just now. It won't corrode human bodies." Chu Qingqiu's calm voice reached their ears.

"Hold your breath!" So Ning Fuyi suddenly shouted. After everyone instinctively obeyed, the thick miasma suddenly descended from the sky, completely swallowing everyone.

Ning Fuyi's ears suddenly became quiet. She could no longer hear the noise of others. Opening her eyes, she was already within the thick miasma, and extending her hand, she could only see the outline of her palm.

At this time, the black smoke behind her suddenly dispersed somewhat. Ning Fuyi immediately summoned her Emei thorns horizontally toward the approaching person, and heard the crisp sound of steel clashing as both quickly withdrew their magical weapons.

Ning Fuyi's wrist was somewhat numb from the shock. She shook her hand and nodded: "It's you."

The person approaching was Liu Wenzhu. She was now very close and could already recognize Ning Fuyi's silhouette, so she nodded: "I don't know where the others are."

Just as she finished speaking, Ning Fuyi suddenly saw a dark shadow with her peripheral vision. She immediately reached out to pull Liu Wenzhu behind her, and a pink barrier surged from her palm, deflecting the dark shadow's force.

The dark shadow immediately disappeared without a trace. Less than a finger-snap later, the dark shadow came again from overhead. Ning Fuyi immediately swung out her Emei thorns, and the thorns stained with pink lightning flew into the thick miasma, accompanied by the roar of a giant beast before flying back to Ning Fuyi's palm.

Ning Fuyi lowered her eyes to look. The previously clean Emei thorns were now covered with foul-smelling bloodstains.

She shook her hand in disgust and heard Liu Wenzhu delicately shout "Yiyi, be careful." A giant hammer immediately brushed past her shoulder, striking the pursuing dark shadow with a crisp sound.

"Are you alright?" Liu Wenzhu's gentle voice wasn't as calm as usual. The familiar feeling enveloped her heart, and Ning Fuyi said she was fine.

Liu Wenzhu breathed a sigh of relief, and then the two turned around, standing back to back, guarding against the dark shadows that might appear from anywhere.

"The resentment is extremely heavy, like a vengeful spirit." Ning Fuyi stroked her Emei thorns, listening for the direction of the dark shadow.

"Yiyi." Liu Wenzhu behind her suddenly spoke, her voice light as a feather. "I miss you very much."

Ning Fuyi accidentally cut her fingertip on the Emei thorn. She quickly withdrew her right hand and said in a low voice: "I truly have dealings with demons now. Don't you resent me?"

Liu Wenzhu paused for a long while before shaking her head: "We promised to accompany each other through life after life. How could I resent you?"

Ning Fuyi took her words to heart, her heart relaxed, and a smile appeared at the corners of her lips. Just then, the dark shadow attacked again from overhead, and she summoned down a bolt of heavenly thunder with lightning speed, pouring all her magnificent power into the thunder, shattering the dark shadow in mid-air.

This strike was too forceful and even startled Liu Wenzhu into half a cry of alarm.

"Yiyi, since you could instantly destroy it, why didn't you act earlier!" Liu Wenzhu said, covering her heart.

"We haven't seen each other for decades. I wanted to say a few words with you." Ning Fuyi waved her hand to dispel the turbid qi from the dark shadow's explosion and smiled.

Liu Wenzhu was speechless with laughter and gently shook her head: "You're indeed still the same as before."

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## Footnotes:

1. **Ning Tian (凝天)** - Literally "Condensing Heaven," the master of Cloud Deep Hall and Liu Wenzhu's mentor.